

Building features
with a team of €100/h devs
is the most expensive way
to ship software.



to ship one feature, the work moved across five handoffs:

- PM writes the ticket
- designer mocks it up
- backend engineer builds the API
- frontend engineer builds the UI
- QA finds the edge cases

= 6 weeks · 3 specialists × €100/h

= ~€72,000 per feature

the formula that drove a decade of software hiring.

same feature. same output. one human, not five:

- **product-wide docs repo** — *humans AND AI read it*
- **PM drafts tickets with AI** — *full company context*
- **AI reads Jira and codes the task**
- **engineer reviews + coordinates** — *no more typing*

= 2 weeks · 1 engineer + AI

= ~€20,000 per feature

the operating model i'm running across three companies.

a year ago vs today, same engineers,
same output:



-70%

cost. 2× the speed.

*most founders are still budgeting against the
old numbers.*

The engineer's job
in 2026 is no longer
to type the code.

It's to review what AI shipped,
coordinate the team,
and decide what's good. *

the three things i installed across the companies:

- i. A product-wide docs repo — engineering, design, bizdev, accounting. Readable by humans AND AI. The shared brain of the company.**

- ii. PMs draft tickets with AI — informed by the full docs repo, not just product specs. Better tickets, faster. AI then reads the tickets in Jira and codes the task.**

- iii. Engineers review + coordinate — they don't type line by line. Judgement, not output. The bottleneck moves from typing speed to taste.**

- Quality, up.
- Shipping speed, up.
- Headcount, down.

same people, paid the same. different leverage. different operating model. the headline numbers tell you what to look at — but they don't tell you what to change.

You need fewer engineers.
More senior.
Paid way above market.

It saves money.
And ships faster.



